

Publish

CONFERENCE EDITION

acp

THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 11, 2025

Welcome to Mobile!

Laissez les bons temps rouler – Let the good times roll!

It is my distinct pleasure to invite you to the 2025 ACP Conference & Trade Show and our 75th anniversary celebration. The conference will take place this year in the historic and culturally rich city of **Mobile, Alabama** - the birthplace of America's Mardi Gras and a vibrant hub of Southern hospitality.

Our conference will be hosted at the elegant **Renaissance Mobile Riverview Plaza Hotel**, ideally situated along the **Mobile River** and right in the heart of the city's charming downtown district. With such an impressive property offered at a special conference rate of only **\$175 per night**, it will be the perfect setting for our annual gathering.

The 2025 conference promises to be an engaging and dynamic experience. You'll have the opportunity to reconnect with colleagues, meet the next generation of Rising Stars, and discover how our valued trade show partners can support your success.

The Conference Planning Committee has been working diligently to craft a thoughtful and enriching agenda. From educational sessions to valuable networking events, every element is designed to help you, and your team grow and thrive.

One exciting change to our typical format this year, is rather than having just one keynote speaker, we have 3! And each speaker will also present a coordinating "workshop" session bringing you multiple important topics and a higher level of expertise!

We are pleased to offer this year's **Leadership Certificate Program**, titled:

"Communicating at the Top of Your Game" Guided by University of South Alabama Professors, Dr. Jeanne Maes and Dr. Jennifer C. Zoghby of the Mitchell College of Business. If you have ever experienced business communication problems, this interactive session is for you! They will explore some of the problems in business communication and suggest practical tools to deal with them.



Attendees can also look forward to **six TLI classes**, including 4 brand new titles and several "visiting professors" to bring fresh content to the TLI sales track.

A highlight of the week will be our **Thursday evening networking event**, a true Mardi Gras party experience! March with us in our very own ACP parade to the Mardi Gras Museum, where we'll have cocktails, dinner and dancing and you'll help us crown a king and queen!

We recognize the time and resources you invest in attending this event, and we are committed to making your experience as valuable and rewarding as possible. We sincerely hope you will join us in **Mobile, Alabama** for what is sure to be a memorable and impactful conference. So grab your masks and get ready to let the good times roll!

Thursday, September 11 Schedule

7:30 am >>> Registration Open

7:45 am >>> Breakfast (in Trade Show Area)
Breakfast Roundtables

8:45 am >>> Welcome & Keynote with
Guy Tasaka

10:30 am >>> Coffee & Speed Networking

12:00 pm >>> Recognition Lunch
(in Trade Show Area)

1:00 pm >>> Breakouts (see chart below)

- TLI Classes

- Leadership Track:

Workshop with Guy Tasaka

2:15 pm >>> Coffee and Vendor
Interaction Session

>>> Rising Stars Special Session

4:30 pm >>> Keynote with Ross Furukawa

6:30 pm >>> Mardi Gras Parade &
Celebration

CONFERENCE KEYNOTE

Local Media 3.0: Transforming Your Publishing Model for the Digital Age

Are you capturing your advertisers' full marketing spend? Most local publishers only get a small share. Local Media 3.0 isn't about ditching print—it's about using your strengths to grow digital revenue. This session explores why the "AND strategy" (print and digital) is essential for sustainability. Learn how to turn print revenue into digital growth, position your publication as a full-service media agency, and thrive—whether you publish a shopper, lifestyle magazine, or hybrid. Guy Tasaka's insights have helped hundreds of publishers modernize their models. Now it's your turn to rethink your strategy and claim a bigger piece of the pie.

Guy Tasaka is a seasoned media executive with deep expertise in digital publishing, research and analytics, strategic planning, and product development. As CEO of Tasaka Digital, he leads innovation in mobile publishing, digital subscriptions, and Connected TV. He has held leadership roles at Calkins Media and The New York Times, where he helped drive digital transformation. A contributor to Editor and Publisher Magazine, Guy shares insights on emerging technologies in media. Named the 2015 Local Media Association's Innovator of the Year, he remains a key voice shaping the future of local media through forward-thinking strategies and innovation.



CONFERENCE KEYNOTE

Lead Generation Tactics and First-Party Data: Boosting Local Media Sales

- Actionable frameworks for contests, newsletters, and local directories
- Low-cost tech tools and platforms
- Case studies of successful community publishers
- Step-by-step guidance on audience segmentation and monetization

Ross Furukawa is a seasoned media entrepreneur and digital marketing strategist with a proven track record of innovating across both traditional and digital publishing environments. Leveraging multi-channel lead generation tactics, AI-driven marketing automation, and integrated tech solutions, he has successfully launched and scaled multiple ventures—from local news platforms and design agencies to comprehensive affiliate networks—delivering measurable ROI and sustainable growth for brands and publications. Ross is the President of Santa Monica Daily Press



WORKSHOP:
LEAD GENERATION Q & A

Thursday, September 11 Schedule

Room:	Mobile Bay 1&2	Mobile Bay 1&2	Mobile Bay 1&2	Mobile Bay 1&2
Day:	Thursday	Friday	Friday	Friday
Time:	1:00 PM	9:00	1:15 PM	3:30 PM
Class:	TLI 256 Digital Sales Success Part 3 Manuel Karam	TLI 260 Taking a Walk in an Entrepreneur's Shoes Kara Ivison	TLI 261 How to Sell Advertising in 2025 Utilizing AI Kenny Katzgrau	TLI 220 Mastering Your Rate Card: Build, Present & Profit Natalie Higgins
Room:	Mobile Bay 3	Mobile Bay 3	Mobile Bay 3	Mobile Bay 3
Day:	Thursday	Friday	Friday	Friday
Time:	1:00 PM		1:15 PM	
Class:	TLI 221 Leveraging Your CVC Audit Tim Bingaman & Jolene Goodman	N/A	TLI 114 Increase Your Sales & Create Long-Term Customers Jolene Goodman	N/A



The Leadership Institute

Lighting the Way



Thursday Evening Mardi Gras Party Networking Dinner

Thursday, September 11, 2025

Time: 6:30 PM – 9:30 PM

Cost: \$109 per person

On Thursday, we take our Mardi Gras Celebration to the next level! Meet us in the hotel lobby to grab a drink and line up for our parade, complete with a second line band to lead us to the History Museum of Mobile for an evening of dinner and cocktails and dancing! Help our Krewe crown the King and Queen of the soiree! Unwind and let loose at this one-of-a-kind networking experience you won't find anywhere else! This event can be added to your registration for \$109 per person. All food and beverages (including alcohol) are included in the price.

The Bill Welsh Memorial Foundation Lottery & Raffle



The Bill Welsh Foundation

If you had attended an AFCP, IFPA or MFCP event over the years, you most likely were greeted by the friendly face of Bill Welsh. You also would appreciate the lasting impact that Bill Welsh has had on our association, our members and our industry. As a tribute and standing testament to those contributions, the Bill Welsh Foundation

was established through the generosity of Kacie Conner and Gary Gerlach. They committed an initial donation of \$10,000 to endow the program as well as necessary legal costs to establish the foundation. The foundation's mission is to focus on supporting educational initiatives for young professionals in the community publication industry.

Kacie and Gary believe that supporting education in the name of Bill Welsh for young professionals to attend conference whose character displays the same natural enthusiasm for the

industry, courageous problem solving, willingness to lead and love of people that was so much a part of Bill. Bill's special love of the community publishing industry and it's participants makes this a most appropriate place to honor his name for years to come.

As a challenge to the rest of the industry, in addition to the initial \$10,000 contribution – Kacie and Gary made the commitment that if the Foundation could raise \$20,000 to add to their initial contribution – they were willing to add another \$10,000 to raise the total funding to \$40,000 in Bill's honor. That challenge was met and the resulting scholarships have helped young professionals get more involved with our industry as well as our annual conferences.

We appreciate Gary and Kacie's generosity and commitment to this program in Bill's honor. Our Silent Action and Lottery Raffle proceeds all go to this worthwhile foundation and the education of the young professionals in our industry. Please generously support these fundraising efforts and celebrate the passion and enthusiasm for the community publishing industry demonstrated by Bill Welsh.



We will be holding a **Silent Auction** throughout the conference. All proceeds from the auction will go to the Bill Welsh Foundation, which supports educational initiatives for young professionals (such as the Rising Stars) in the industry. We encourage everyone to bid high and bid often! We appreciate your participation and support! Thank you to those who donated!

\$5 Each or 5 for \$20

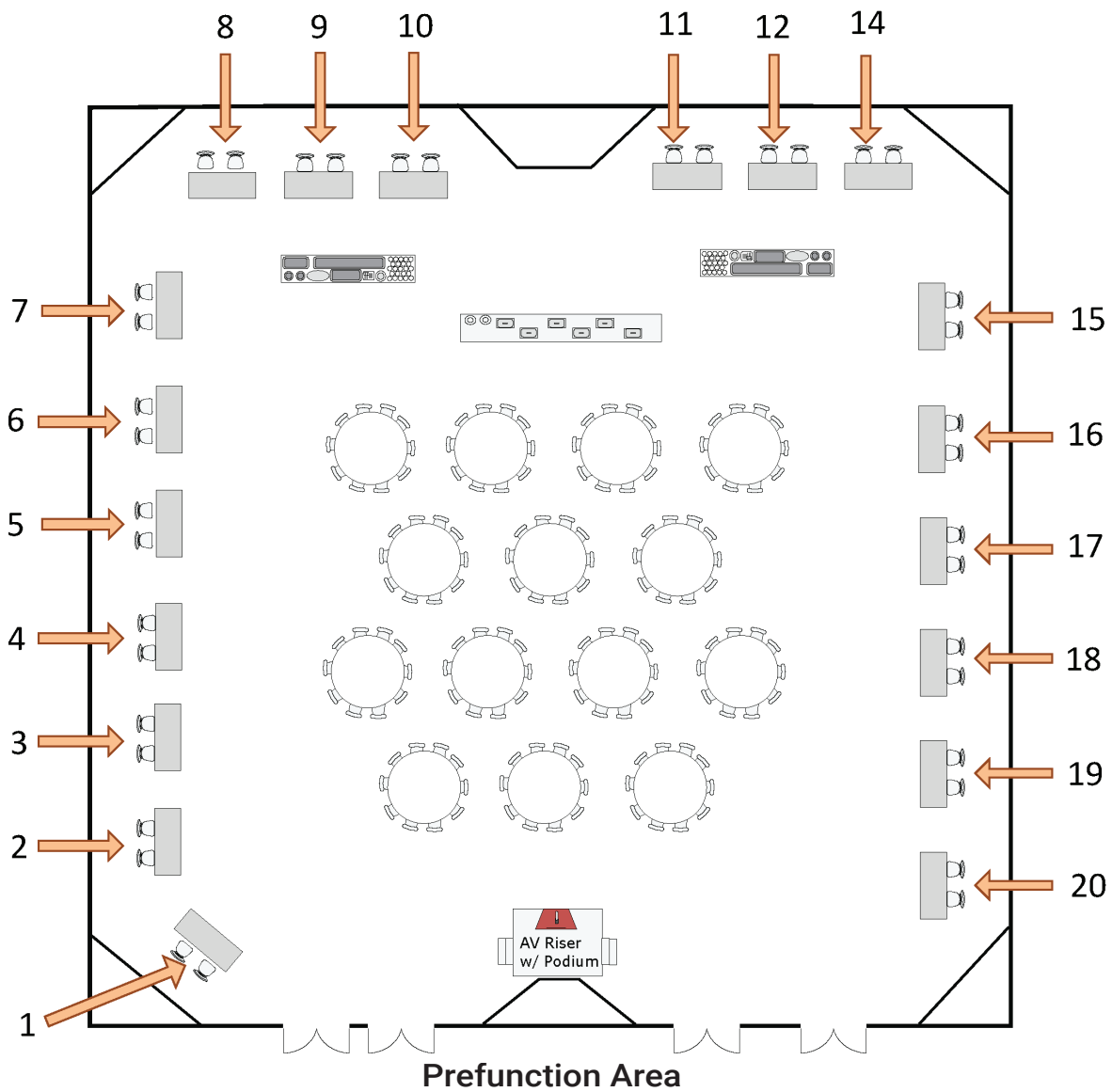
Potential to WIN UP TO
\$2,209,120.00

Also, back by popular demand, the **Lottery Board** will be in play throughout conference to benefit the Bill Welsh Foundation as well! This exciting raffle was such a huge success in Norfolk that we decided to bring it back in 2025. ACP purchased \$100 worth of scratch off tickets and one lucky winner will have a chance at winning millions! Winner takes all, so be sure join in on the excitement!

Winner will be announced at closing ceremonies

All proceeds go to Bill Welsh Memorial Foundation sponsor of Rising Stars

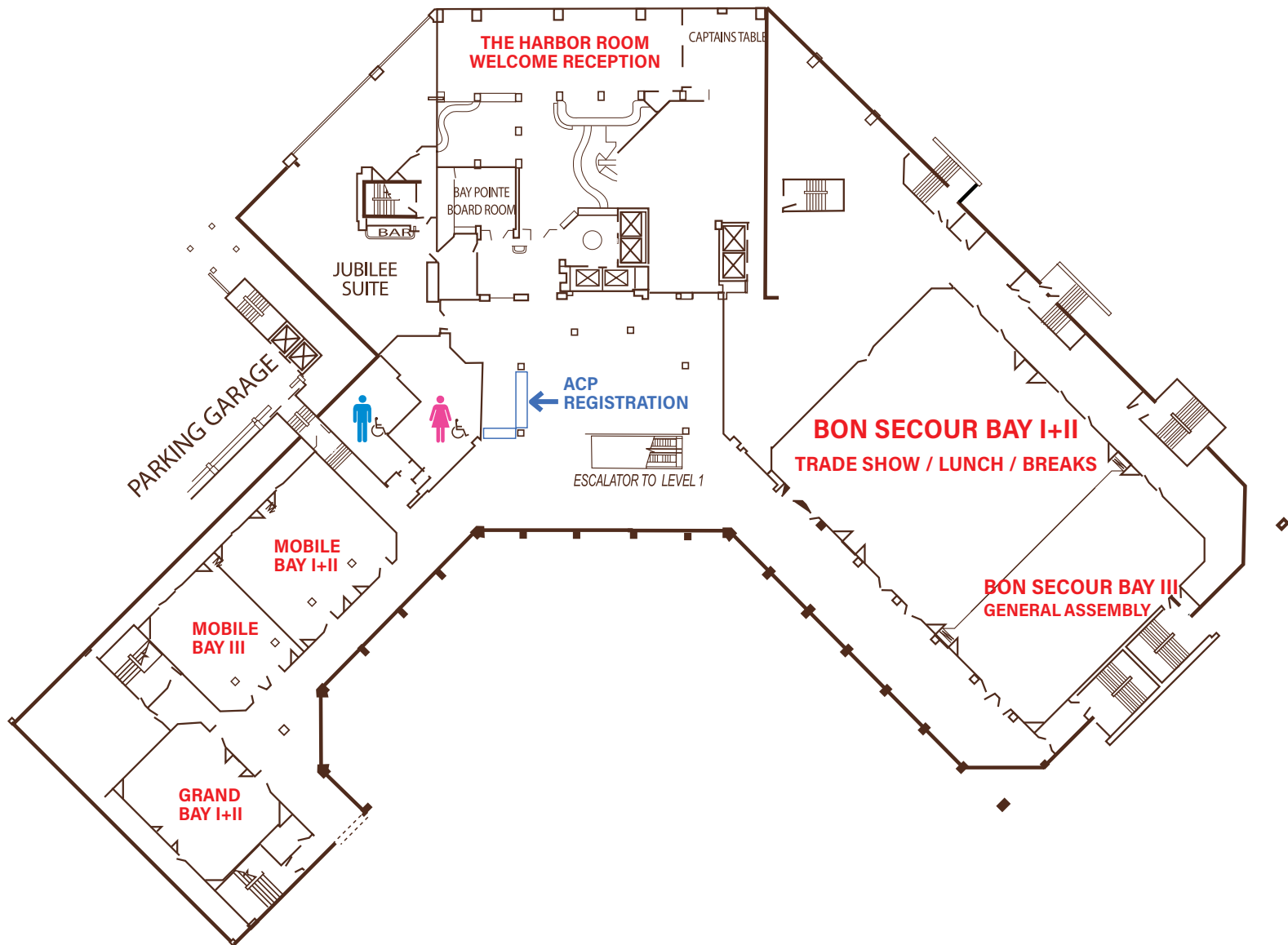
Trade Show Locator Map



BOOTH	COMPANY NAME	BOOTH	COMPANY NAME	BOOTH	COMPANY NAME
1	January Spring	8	PopMount	16	Design2Pro
2	Publication Printers	9	Newspaper Manager	17	TBD
3	Metro Creative	10	Cummings Printing	18	TBD
4	Creative Circle Media	11	Broadstreet Media	19	TBD
5	All In One Insights	12	SCS	20	Publish Magazine
6	Newspaper CRM	14	Alternative Newsweekly Foundation		
7	CVC	15	Advantage Newspaper Consultants		

Renaissance Mobile Riverview Meeting Space Map

MEETING SPACE - DECK TWO





PLATINUM SPONSORS



Publication Printers corp.

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METR @115 YEARS



SILVER SPONSORS

